



Franz Boas

1906

✦ THE SHAPING
OF AMERICAN
ANTHROPOLOGY
1883-1911 ✦

A Franz Boas Reader

EDITED BY

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me the importance of studying the interaction between the organic and the inorganic, above all between the life of a people and their physical environment. Thus arose my plan to regard as my life's task the [following] investigation: How far may we consider the phenomena of organic life, and especially those of the psychic life, from a mechanistic point of view, and what conclusions can be drawn from such a consideration? In order to solve such questions I need at least a general knowledge of physiology, psychology, and sociology, which up to now I do not possess and must acquire.

I am sorry I cannot send you any of my papers in time. [Here follows a list of the psychophysical papers Boas published in 1882.] I have for the present given up my psychophysical work, as there was no time to make experiments during my military training. [Here follows a reference to a paper in physics shortly to be published.] At present I am studying the dependence of the migration of the present-day Eskimo on the configuration and physical conditions of the land. This is, of course, a very extensive piece of work and cannot be finished so soon. I am taking it up chiefly from a methodological standpoint, in order to discover how far one can get, by studying a very special and not simple case, in determining the relationship between the life of a people and environment.

If I should in the near future have an opportunity to study, I would try to solve these questions. In addition, I wish to finish up and summarize my psychophysical studies, for which I need more material for observation before I can finish up properly. I have further a few smaller meteorological studies which I should like to finish up as quickly as possible, so that I may give all my energy to working on the question which I have chosen as my life's work.



SELECTION 5

A Year Among the Eskimo

If I undertake to describe some of my Arctic experiences I cannot entertain you with exciting adventures, such as shipwrecks and narrow escapes, for such were not my share. My narrative must be that of the daily life of the inhabitants of these ice-bound coasts, the Eskimo. They were my companions in all my journeys. I used to travel from

village to village, and thus their fortunes were my fortune. The little adventures of their life were my adventures, and I hope what my description may seem to be wanting in exciting scenes and imminent dangers will be made good by the fact that my experiences are those of a whole people, that my difficulties and dangers were such as the Eskimo have to brave and to struggle with throughout their lives.

When our ship first approached the gloomy shores of Baffin Land—one of the large islands forming the Arctic archipelago—the Eskimo descried us, manned a boat, and boarded our schooner. Little did I think that within a short time I should look at yon little filthy fellow, with long hair and sparkling eyes, with feelings of hearty interest, not to say friendship; little did I think how warmly they would welcome me in their small huts.

After a few days the ship left us, and I was alone with my servant among the Eskimo. I think it is unnecessary to describe their low statures and flat faces; their neatly finished skin dresses, and the long-tailed jackets of the women, who carry their children about in the huge hoods of their jackets, or in their wide boots, which reach to the hips. Neither will I speak about their swift craft, the kayak, which they skilfully manage with the double-bladed paddle.

September and the first days of October were spent with brief excursions in the neighborhood of the place where I had landed, for it was too late in the season to undertake extensive journeys. The brown slopes of the mountains began to be covered again with a white coat of snow, and ice was forming in the bays. Only a few weeks more and gales were raging over the sea; ice was forming rapidly, and winter had come. The Eskimo had built snow huts and stone houses, which were covered with shrubs and turf. Large lamps were burning inside, affording light and heat. The ice-floes had consolidated under the shelter of the land, and the men went out every day to hunt seals at the edge of the floe. There they stood waiting for a seal to rise. As soon as the hunter sees it the harpoon is thrown, and the carcass drawn upon the ice. The hunters must watch the state of the weather; for if a sudden gale blowing from the land should arise, the ice is liable to break, and to be carried into the sea. I recollect a young man who was thus cut off from the land, and found himself unable to return to the coast. For eight days he drifted to and fro at the mercy of the winds. Heavy snow-falls covered the drifting ice, the swell broke up the floe, and death stared at him continually. Yet he did not despair, nor even lose his temper, but in mockery of his own misfortune he composed the following song:

Aya: It's glorious on the ice!

Here it's nice.

Behold my lonesome path!

All snow and slush and ice!

This is nice!

- Aya: It's glorious on the ice!
 Here it's nice.
 Behold my native land!
 Its snow and slush and ice!
 This is nice.
- Aya: Awaking from my slumbers in the dawn,
 Monotonous fields of ice
 And gloomy lanes of water
 I behold.
- Aya: O when I reach the land
 It will be nice!
 When will this roaming end?
 When will I be at home?
 Then it's nice!

As it grew colder the floe grew more extensive, and about the beginning of December the sea was sufficiently frozen over for travelling. This is the time of the year when the natives visit one another, and therefore it was the most favorable season for my travels and explorations. I had purchased a sledge and dogs, and in the beginning of winter made short excursions in order to learn how to drive a sledge. In December I started on my first journey, and henceforth until about the end of July I was continually moving about, surveying the coasts and the interior of Baffin Land.

I used to stay in the Eskimo villages and to survey the neighborhood. As soon as this work was finished, I proceeded to the next village, and thus worked my way all along the coast. In the villages I lived with the Eskimo in their snow-houses. Generally I proposed to a man who was well acquainted with the country to join me for a few days, and as I had better dogs and a better sledge than the Eskimo, my offer was gladly accepted. Such trips lasted generally about a fortnight, and during that time the man went sealing while I was surveying.

I shall describe one day of such travels, as this will convey a fair idea of the out-door life of the Eskimo in winter.

Early in the morning the woman cooked the breakfast, while the man prepared the sledge. The latter consists simply of low runners connected by a number of crossbars. When in use, the bottom of the runners is covered with a coating of ice, that the sledge may glide more smoothly over the snow. The load consisted of our sleeping-bags, my astronomical instruments, our hunting gear, snow-knives, a lamp, and a lump of seal meat and blubber. After this light load was secured by lashing, the dogs were harnessed up and put into the sledge. Now we were ready to start. On the first day of a journey the dogs are generally well rested, and then it is difficult to keep them back until all is ready. As soon as the driver cries "Hi!" off they go down the snow-banks, down over boulders of ice that are piled up on the shore. The sledge bounces over all obstacles,

and it requires all the strength and attention of the traveller to hold to it and to keep clear of projecting rocks and pieces of ice.

When the sledge gets to the unbroken floe which covers the sea, the harnesses and traces of the dogs must be looked after before the party is ready to proceed. When all is in good order, the travellers sit down on the sledge, the driver in the front part; he takes up the whip, which is about twenty-five feet long, and off they go.

It is very pleasant to ride on a light sledge drawn by good dogs, when the ice is level and the snow hard. Under such circumstances one can easily accomplish about seventy miles in a day's drive. But even then driving is a hard work and requires considerable skill and attention. After a short while one or the other of the dogs will get lazy. Then the driver calls out his name and lashes him; but it is necessary to hit the dog called, for if another is struck, he feels wronged and will turn upon the dog whose name has been called; the leader, who will not allow any fighting among his dogs, enters into the quarrel, and soon the whole pack is huddled up in one howling and biting mass, and no amount of lashing and beating will separate the fighting animals. The only thing one can do is to wait until their wrath has abated, and then to clear the traces, which have become so entangled that they must be restrung.

But caution is necessary in doing so. The dogs are made to lie down by lashing their heads gently. While the traces are being strung, the leader looks back cunningly, and as soon as all is ready he jumps to his feet, all other dogs follow him, and away they go before the driver can fairly get hold of the sledge. Or, if one succeeds in that, the whip and mittens will remain behind and it is necessary to drive back in a wide circle in order to recover them.

Before I was acquainted with all the peculiarities of the dogs, I frequently spoke to my companion, asking him the names of promontories, bays, islands, etc. While we were talking the dogs turned round and all of a sudden sat down, facing us as though they wanted to know what we were talking about. They absolutely allow no conversation between the travellers, but one has always to speak to them. The driver will say: "Aq aq—now run, now run! Ah! do you see yon island, yon little island? There is a house on it, a nice little house! Now run!" and so on. If he wants to turn to the right, he throws his whip to the left and sings out: "Aua, ja aua, au aua," and as long as he continues to do so, the dogs turn more and more to the right. If it is very cold, one has to run now and then by the side of the sledge, in order to keep warm, and thus one is fairly tired out when it is time to stop and to make a camp.

The first thing to be done is to build a snow-house. Snow blocks are cut with a knife or a dove-tail saw and then arranged so as to form a vault. Of course, such a house, which is built for a single night only, is very small, but nevertheless it takes about two hours to finish it. Then the fire is lighted and some snow is melted. While one of the men is engaged

in this work, the other unharnesses the dogs and takes the harnesses into the house. The sledge is unloaded and every thing carried into the hut, as else the dogs would devour it. It takes about four hours until the travellers are ready for their meal, which invariably consists of raw, frozen seal meat and water. As I was provided with better cooking accommodations than the Eskimo have, we were able to cook coffee or soup, and this was a great attraction for the Eskimo when travelling with me. The clothing is not taken off during the night, but kept on until a longer stay is made. These snow-huts do not get very warm during a single night, when the glass is 40° or 50° below zero, though the door is sealed with a snow-block and the lamp is kept burning all night. Therefore the nights are rather uncomfortable, particularly as the houses are so small that one cannot sit with extended legs. I was generally glad to get under way again in the next morning and to pursue my journey.

I described here the travelling over smooth ice and over hard snow. When the traveller has to pass fields of rough ice, and when deep and soft snow obstructs the way, travelling is even more laborious. The driver has to go on the right side of the sledge, and to push it on, and to steer it past the boulders of ice with the whole of his strength. He must stimulate the dogs continually; and nevertheless they will sit down every few minutes and look piteously at their master, as though they wanted to say: "We cannot do any more." When sudden snowfalls overtake travelling parties, their lives are even sometimes endangered. Seals do not frequent the broken floes, and besides, the snow conceals their breathing-holes. In winter we were overtaken by an occurrence of this kind. Our party consisted of three, an Eskimo, my servant, and myself. As it was my very first trip we did not know much about travelling. When about twenty-five miles distant from the settlement I intended to visit, a snowfall set in which covered the ice with from two to four feet of snow. Our dogs were absolutely unable to move on, and so we had to leave behind sledge, dogs, and every thing, and to make our way to the settlement on foot. After a laborious march of about three miles, fog set in, we struck a floe of rough ice, and ere long we had lost our way. The compass was of no use, as I did not know the position of the place. Fortunately, after a few hours, the moon made her appearance and the fog lifted. But only after a march of thirty hours at a temperature of 48° below zero, and all the time travelling over rough ice, and for many hours through deep snow, did we succeed in finding the village. My unfortunate servant had frozen his feet, and had to stay in that place for several months.

It was at this time that I learned to know Eskimo hospitality. When we entered the hut my new friend was eager to help us to throw off our clothing, and we were given a warm bed. While we were asleep a seal was cut, though, in consequence of the bad weather, provisions were scanty; and a hearty meal was cooked, which was served to us as soon as we awoke. Meanwhile the "lady of the house" had dried our clothing and

was busy mending it. In short, we were made as comfortable as possible. In the evening all were assembled in our home, some sitting on the ledge, some squatting or standing on the floor, eager to hear of our misfortune. During the night a gale was blowing, which hardened the snow; and therefore several men set out the next morning to fetch our provisions and our dogs. Such are the incidents and difficulties of winter travelling; but it is agreeable and pleasant as compared to sledging in summer. Then the ice is covered with water to a depth of three or four feet. The traveller has to wade through this ice-cold lake, and he must be careful to avoid the large whirlpools which form over each seal hole, and the rapid streams which gush down the cracks that cross the flow in every direction. And all is glaring in a bright blue and white, which hurts the eyes and causes snow-blindness.

But I will return to my winter journeys. I said before that while I was surveying, the Eskimo used to go sealing. The hunting of seals is a very tiresome and disagreeable work in winter. The seals scratch holes through the ice, in which they rise to breathe. The dogs scent these holes, and when one is found, the hunter waits by its side until he hears the breathing animal. Sometimes he will stand there motionless for a whole day, the harpoon in his right hand, the harpoon line coiled up over his left arm. As soon as he hears the animal he throws the harpoon vertically downward.

In spring another method of hunting is used. At this season the seals crawl upon the ice and lie by the side of their holes, sleeping and basking. Every now and then the cautious animal raises its head and looks around to ascertain whether somebody is approaching. The Eskimo, who wear seal-skin clothing at this time of the year, lie down on the ice and creep up to the seal. When the animal looks up they will lie down and imitate its movements. When it lies down again they approach it cautiously. At last they get near enough to strike it with the harpoon.

In the beginning of winter I had occasion to see one of the great festivals of these Eskimo, which is of more than common interest, as it is closely connected with their religious ideas. When late in the fall storms rage over the land, and again release the sea from its icy fetters; when the floes are pressed one against another and piled up in wild disorder, the Eskimo believes he hears the voices of the spirits which inhabit the mischief-laden air. They beleaguer the villages and bring sickness and death, bad weather and failure in hunting. The worst of these spirits are Sedna, mistress of the under-world, and her father, to whom the dead Eskimo fall.

The old legends which mothers relate during the long winter nights to their timidly listening children, tell of Sedna: Once upon a time there lived a man with his daughter Sedna on a lonely place. His wife had been dead for a long time, and the two led a quiet life. Sedna grew up to be a beautiful girl, and the young men came in from all around to sue for her

hand, but none of them could win her proud heart. One spring-time, when the ice had broken up, a fulmar flew from over the sea and wooed Sedna with enticing song. "Come to me," he said, "come into the land of the birds, where there is never any hunger. My tent is made of beautiful bird-skins; my brethren, the fulmars, shall bring you all your heart may desire; their feathers will clothe you; your lamp shall always be filled with oil, your pot with meat." Sedna could not resist such wooing, and they went together into the land of the birds. When at last they reached the country of the bird, after a long journey, Sedna discovered that her spouse had shamefully deceived her. Her tent was covered with wretched fish-skins, full of holes, that gave free entrance to the wind and snow. Instead of white reindeer-skins, her bed was made of hard walrus-hides; and she had to live on miserable fish which the birds brought her. Too soon she discovered that she had thrown her fortune away when, in her foolish pride, she had rejected the Eskimo youth. In her woe she sang:

"Aya! O father, if you knew how wretched I am, you would come to me, and we would hurry away in your boat over the waters. The birds look unkindly upon me, the stranger. The cold winds roar around my bed; they give me miserable food—oh, come and take me back home! Aya."

When a year had passed, and the sea was again stirred with warmer winds, the father left his land to visit Sedna. The daughter greeted him joyfully, and besought him to take her back home. The father pitying his daughter took her in his boat while the birds were out hunting, and they quickly left the country which had brought so much sorrow to Sedna. When the fulmar came home in the evening and found his wife not there, he got very angry. He called his fellows around him, and they all flew away in search of the fugitives. They soon discerned them and stirred up a great storm. The sea rose in immense waves, that threatened the pair with destruction. In his mortal peril the father determined to offer Sedna up to the birds, and threw her overboard. She clung with a death-grip to the edge of the boat. The cruel father then took a knife and cut off the first joints of her fingers. Falling into the sea they were transformed into seals. Sedna clung to the boat more tightly, the second finger-joints fell under the sharp knife, and swam away as ground-seals; when the father cut off the stumps of the fingers, they became whales.

In the meantime the storm had subsided, for the fulmars thought Sedna was drowned. The father then allowed her to come into the boat again. But she from that time cherished a deadly hatred against him, and swore bitter revenge. After they got ashore, she commanded her dogs to gnaw off the feet and hands of her father while he was asleep. Upon this he cursed himself, his daughter, and the dogs who had maimed him; then the earth opened and swallowed hut, father, daughter, and dogs. They have since lived in the land of Adlivun, of which Sedna is the mistress.

The seals, ground-seals, and whales, which grew from Sedna's fingers, increased rapidly, and soon filled all the waters, affording choice food to the Eskimo. But since then Sedna hates them as they hunt and kill the creatures which have arisen from her flesh and blood. Her father, who can only move by creeping, appears to the dying; and the wizards often see his crippled hand seizing and taking away the dead. The dead have to stay a year in Sedna's dismal abode. Two large dogs lie on the threshold, and only move aside to let the dead enter. It is dark and cold inside. No bed of reindeer-skins invites to rest, but the new-comer has to lie on hard walrus-hides. Only those who have been good and brave on the earth escape Sedna, and lead happy lives in the upper land of Kudlivun. This land is full of reindeer; it is never cold there, and snow and ice never visit it. Those, also, who have died a violent death, may go into the fields of the blessed. But whoever has been with Sedna must always stay in the land of Adlivun, and hunt whales and walrus. With all the other evil spirits, Sedna lingers in the fall among the Eskimo. But while the others fill the air and the water, she rises from under the ground. It is then a busy season for the wizards. In every hut we may hear singing and praying, and conjuring the spirits is going on in every house. The lamps burn low. The wizard sits in a mystic gloom in the rear of the hut. He has thrown off his outer coat, and drawn the hood of his inner garment over his head. Muttering indistinguishable words, he shakes his hands feverishly. He utters sounds which it is hard to ascribe to a human voice. At last his guardian spirit responds to the invocation. The priest lies in a trance, and when he comes to himself he promises, in incoherent phrases, the help of the good spirits.

The hardest task, that of driving away Sedna, is reserved for the most powerful wizards. A rope is coiled on the floor of a large hut, in such a manner as to leave a small opening at the top, which represents the breathing-hole of a seal. Two wizards stand by the side of it, one of them holding the seal spear in his hand as if he were watching at the seal hole in the winter, the other holding the harpoon-line. Another priest sits in the rear of the hut, whose office it is to lure Sedna up with magic song. At last she comes up through the hard rocks, and the men hear her heavy breathing; now she emerges from the ground, and meets the wizards waiting at the hole. She is harpooned, and sinks away in angry haste, drawing after her the harpoon, to which the two men hold with all their strength. Only by a desperate effort does she tear herself away from it and return to her dwelling in Adlivun. Nothing is left with the two men but the blood-sprinkled harpoon, which they proudly show.

Sedna and the other evil spirits are at last driven away, and a great festival for young and old is celebrated on the next day in honor of the event. But they must still be careful, for the wounded Sedna is greatly enraged, and will seize any one whom she can find outside of his hut. So, on that day, they all wear protecting amulets on the tops of their hoods.

The men assemble early in the middle of the settlement. As soon as they have all got together, they run screaming and jumping around the houses, following the course of the sun. The circuit made, they visit every hut, where the woman must be waiting for them. When she hears the noise of the band, she comes out and throws a dish of little gifts of meat, ivory trinkets, and articles of seal-skin into the yelling crowd, of which each one helps himself to what he can get. No hut is spared in this round.

The men next divide into two parties: the ptarmigans, those who were born in the winter; and the ducks, or the children of summer. A large thong of seal-skin is stretched out. Each party takes hold of one end and tries with all its might to drag the opposite party over to its side. If the ptarmigans give way, then the summer has won the game, and fine weather may be expected to prevail during the coming months.

The contest of the seasons having been decided, the women bring out a large kettle of water and each person gets his drinking cup. The company stand close around the kettle, while the oldest man steps out first among them. He dips a cup of water from the vessel, sprinkles a few drops on the ground, turns his face towards the home of his youth, and states his name and that of the place where he was born. He is followed by all the other inhabitants of the village, down to the youngest children, who are represented by their mothers. As the words of the old are listened to respectfully, those of distinguished hunters are received with demonstrative applause.

Now arises a cry of surprise, and all eyes are turned toward a hut out of which stalk two gigantic figures. They wear heavy boots: their legs are swelled out to a wonderful thickness by several pairs of breeches, their shoulders are covered with a woman's jacket, and their faces with a hideous mask of seal-skin. In their right hands they carry the harpoon, on their backs inflated buoys of seal-skin, and in their left the scraper with which skins are prepared. Silently, with long strides, the Kailertatang approach the assembly, who, screaming, press back from before them. The pair solemnly lead the men to a suitable spot, and set them in a row, against which they set the women in an opposite row. They match the men and women in pairs, and these run, pursued by the Kailertatang, to the hut of the woman, where they stay for the following day. Having performed this duty the Kailertatang go down to the shore and invoke the north wind which brings fair weather, while they warn off the unfavorable south wind.

As soon as the incantation is over, all the men attack the Kailertatang with a great noise. They act as if they had weapons in their hands and would kill both the spirits. One pretends to probe them with the spear, another to stab them with a knife; one to cut off their arms and legs, another to beat them unmercifully on the head. The buoy which they carry on their backs is ripped open and collapses, and soon they both lie

as if dead beside their broken weapons. The Eskimo leave them to get their drinking-cups, and the Kailertatang awake to new life. Each man pours some water into their buoys, passes a cup to them, and inquires about the future, about the fortunes of hunt and the events of life. The Kailertatang answer in murmurs, which the questioner must interpret for himself.

I told before a tradition of the Eskimo. They are very fond of telling such tales and have an enormous stock of folk-lore, of which I succeeded in collecting a considerable amount. The scene when traditions are told is extremely interesting, and I welcomed such occasions, as nothing can be more instructive to the traveller than to listen to the songs and legends of the people he studies. The man who relates the tradition strips off his outer jacket and sits down in the rear of the hut facing the wall. He pulls up his hood, puts on his mittens, and prepares himself by a brief song. The audience stand or squat on the floor of the huts, and now the lamps are lowered, a dim light only filling the small room. I shall tell here one of the most characteristic of these stories, as I heard it in a village on Davis Strait.

The Tale of Qaudjaqdjuq

A long time ago there was a poor little orphan boy who had no protector and was maltreated by all the inhabitants of the village. He was not even allowed to sleep in the hut, but lay outside in the cold passage among the dogs, who were his pillows and his quilt. Neither did they give him any meat, but flung old, tough walrus-hide at him, which he was compelled to eat without a knife. Thus he led a miserable life and did not grow at all, but remained poor little Qaudjaqdjuq. He did not even dare to join the play of the other children, as they also maltreated him on account of his weakness.

When the inhabitants of the village assembled for dancing and feasting Qaudjaqdjuq used to lie in the passage and to peep over the threshold. Now and then a man would lift him by the nostrils into the hut and tease him. As he was thus frequently lifted by the nostrils they grew to be very large, though he remained small and weak.

At last the man in the moon, who had seen how badly the men behaved towards Qaudjaqdjuq, came down to help him. He harnessed his dogs to his sledge and drove down. When near the hut he stopped and cried: "Qaudjaqdjuq, come out!" Qaudjaqdjuq answered: "I will not come, go away!" But when he was asked a second and third time to come out he complied, though he was much frightened. Then the man in the moon went with him to a place where some large boulders were lying about, and, having whipped him, asked: "Do you feel stronger now?" Qaudjaqdjuq answered: "Yes, I feel stronger." "Then lift yon boulder," said he.

As Qaudjaqdjuq was not yet able to lift it, he gave him another whipping, and now all of a sudden he began to grow, the feet first becoming of an extraordinary size. Again the man in the moon asked him: "Do you feel stronger now?" Qaudjaqdjuq answered: "Yes, I feel stronger," but as he could not yet lift the stone he was whipped once more, after which he had attained a very great strength and lifted the boulder as though it were a small pebble. The man in the moon said: "That will do. To-morrow morning I shall send three bears; then you may show your strength."

He returned to the moon, but Qaudjaqdjuq, who had now become Qaudjuqdjuq (*i.e.*, the big Qaudjaqdjuq), returned home, tossing the stones with his feet, and making them fly to the right and to the left. At night he lay down again among the dogs to sleep. Next morning he awaited the bears, and, indeed, three large animals soon made their appearance, frightening all the men, who did not dare to leave the huts.

Then Qaudjuqdjuq put on his boots and ran down to the ice. The men who looked out of the window said: "Look here, is not that Qaudjaqdjuq? The bears will soon make way with him." But he seized the first by its hind legs and smashed its head on an iceberg, near which it happened to stand; the other one fared no better; the third, however, he carried up to the village, and slew some of his persecutors with it. Others he pressed to death with his hands, or tore off their heads, crying: "That is for your abusing me! that is for your maltreating me!" Those whom he did not kill ran away, never to return. Only a few who had been kind to him while he was poor little Qaudjaqdjuq were spared. He lived to be a great hunter, and travelled all over the country, accomplishing many exploits.

In this story the man in the moon appears as the protector of orphans. He is one of the mighty spirits in the Eskimo mythology. But besides him, a great number of minor spirits are known. They are called Tornait, and appear in the shape of men, bears, or stones. By their help a man may become what is called angakoq, a kind of priest or wizard. The spirits help him to discover the causes of sickness and death, and therefore he is the medicine-man. In their incantations they use a peculiar language, which consists to a great extent of archaic roots, and it is remarkable that some of these words which I collected on the coast of Baffin Bay are found in the language of Alaskan tribes. This shows that a close connection existed in olden times between the Eskimo of North-eastern America and the inhabitants of Alaska. The angakoq, or the priest, exercises a great power over the minds of the Eskimo. His commands are strictly obeyed, and his prescriptions regarding the abstaining of certain kinds of work or food are rigidly observed. It is strange that the Eskimo, who have a very limited supply of food animals, should restrict themselves in regard to food. Still their regulations on this subject are numerous. For instance, it is absolutely impossible to induce them to eat walrus meat during the deer-hunting season, or *vice versa*. Seal

and deer must not be brought into contact, and, although they are not at all cleanly, they wash themselves every time before changing from one food to the other. It is generally believed that the Eskimo are extremely filthy, but I can assure you that this is not so everywhere. In a few huts in Cumberland Sound I found the inhabitants cleanly and good-looking in every respect, while in other places it was quite the reverse. I remember one village, which I visited in winter. Every thing looked so filthy and full of walrus oil that I was really disgusted. When I returned to the tribe in Cumberland Sound I told of my observation. Then all the Eskimo laughed, and a woman said to me: "Did not you know that? They are like the fulmars—when they see blubber they will sit down in it and eat away. They do not mind it when they soil their white coats. But we are like the gulls. We also have to take our food from the blubber and oil, but, like those birds, we keep clear of it, and carefully pick out whatever we want."

The trip to the tribe I mentioned just now was remarkable in several respects. In Eskimoland the arrival of strangers is an event, and great ceremonies are connected with it. The natives of the village stand up in a row, playing with small balls and singing. A strong man stands in front of the row and awaits the stranger. The latter approaches, his arms folded over his breast, his head inclined to the right side. Then the native strikes him a terrible blow on the cheek, and then in his turn awaits the blow of the stranger. Thus they continue a long while, until one of the men is vanquished. At the end of the performance the stranger is invited into the huts, and henceforth he is the friend and companion of the natives. When I arrived the men did not know who was coming, and arranged themselves in a row. But as soon as they discovered the white man, the first to visit their settlement, they set up a terrific howling, which induced the women and children to pour forth from the low huts, and then all began a dancing and crying and singing that still rings in my ears. The news: "*Qodlunaq! qodlunaq!*" *i.e.*, "A white man! a white man!" had spread with incredible rapidity over the village. Everybody was eager to see the new-comer; the children hid timidly behind the long frock-like tails of their mothers' jackets, and cried with fear and excitement. In short, it was a scene that will always stand foremost in my recollections of Eskimo life.

After all the many little adventures, and after a long and intimate intercourse with the Eskimo, it was with feelings of sorrow and regret that I parted from my Arctic friends. I had seen that they enjoyed life, and a hard life, as we do; that nature is also beautiful to them; that feelings of friendship also root in the Eskimo heart; that, although the character of their life is so rude as compared to civilized life, the Eskimo is a man as we are; that his feelings, his virtues, and his shortcomings are based in human nature, like ours.